

List of Kanji

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漢字 1: Public (公)

		
Public.		
In many instances, this character serves as the opposite to 私 (Entry ??, page ??).		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	八 + ム
English	Eight (volcano) + Private

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Public	[volcanoes] are being [privatized].

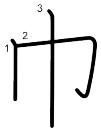
♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	コウ (KŌ)	—
L.C.	ク (KU)	おおやけ (ōyake)

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations	
Publicly	⟨CAUSE⟩ ⟨COOKING⟩ of <ore yuck>.

+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
公有	public + have = <i>publicly owned</i>	コウ・ユウ (KŌ-YŪ)
公安	public + ease = <i>public peace</i>	コウ・アン (KŌ-AN)
公開	public + open = <i>open to the public</i>	コウ・カイ (KŌ-KAI)
公金	public + gold (money) = <i>public funds</i>	コウ・キン (KŌ-KIN)
公道	public + road = <i>public road</i>	コウ・ドウ (KŌ-DŌ)
公会	public + meet = <i>public meeting</i>	コウ・カイ (KŌ-KAI)

{...} Sample Sentence	
この 公園 は 全て の 人 に	公開されて いる。
この コウ エン は すべて の ひと に	コウカ イされて いる
this park は all の person に	open to the public
<i>The park is open to everybody.</i>	

漢字 2: Cloth (巾)

		
Cloth. Rag.		
This character frequently appears as a component in other 漢字.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	巾
English	Cloth

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Part of the 漢字 radicals (#50).	

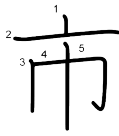
♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	キン (KIN)	—
L.C.	はば (haba)	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations	
Clothe	the ⟨KINDRED⟩ with <habaneros>.
‡Habaneros is a hot variety of chilli peppers.	

+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
巾	<i>cloth, rag</i>	キン (KIN)
巾着	cloth + wear = <i>pouch (for coins, etc.)</i>	キン・チャク (KIN-CHAKU)

{...} Sample Sentence	
あそこ に 巾着 を 掛けて 下さい。	
あそこ に キン チャク を かけて ください	
over there に pouch を hang please	
<i>Please hang the pouch over there.</i>	

漢字 3: City (市)

市		
City.		
A secondary meaning relates to <i>market</i> . In this sense the character can refer to anything from a <i>simple fair</i> to the idea of a <i>general business market</i> .		
This will be the first of four 漢字 in this chapter connected with groups of people living in a defined area; moving from larger to smaller units will provide a sense of their relative sizes.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	亠 + 巾
English	Top/Lid + Cloth
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Cities	with many [top]less [clothes].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	シ (SHI)	—
L.C.	—	いち (ichi)

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

City	〈SHIELDED〉 from <itchiness>.
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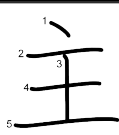
+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
市	<i>city</i>	シ (SHI)
市内	city + inside = <i>within the city</i>	シ・ナイ (SHINAI)
市外	city + outside = <i>outside the city</i>	シ・ガイ (SHIGAI)
市立	city + stand = <i>municipal</i>	シ・リツ (SHIRITSU)
市有	city + have = <i>city-owned</i>	シ・ユウ (SHI-YŪ)

{...} Sample Sentence

夜	は	一人	で	市内	を	歩かないで	下さい。
よる	は	ひとり	で	シナイ	を	あるくしないで	ください
night	は	1 person	で	within the city	を	don't walk	please
Please don't walk alone at night in the city.							

漢字 4: Primary (主)

主		
Primary.		
This character conveys a sense of <i>importance</i> and <i>authority</i> ; it is used in this vein with both concrete objects and abstract ideas.		
Note the difference between this 漢字 and that for “Jewel” in Entry ?? (玉, page ??).		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	丶 + 王
English	Dot + King
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
The primary	[king] is [bejewelled] at the top of his head.

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Primarily	made from <new sheep>, this 〈SHOOTING〉 〈SUIT〉 can be placed in <omo>.
‡Omo	is a laundry detergent used for stain removal.

+ Words and Compounds

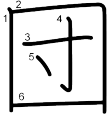
Example	English	Pronunciation
主力	main + strength = <i>main force</i>	シュ・リョク (SHURYOKU)
主人公	main + person + public = <i>main character</i>	シュ・ジン・コウ (SHU-JIN-KŌ)
*売主	sell + primary = <i>seller</i>	うりぬし (urinushi)
*持主	hold + primary = <i>owner</i>	もちぬし (mochinushi)

{...} Sample Sentence

主人公	は	有名	な	美人	です。
シュジンコウ	は	ユウメイ	な	ビジン	です
main character	は	famous	な	beautiful woman	be / is
The main character is a famously beautiful person.					

{...} Sample Sentence						
西山さん	の	友人	は	南米	から	来ました。
にしやまさん	の	ユウジン	は	ナンベイ	から	きました
Nishiyama-san	の	friend	は	South America	from	came
<i>Nishiyama-san's friend came from South America.</i>						

漢字 7: Group (団)

		
Group.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	口 + 寸
English	Enclosure/Box/Prison + Inch

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Group	together [tiny] [prisons].

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ダン (DAN)	—
L.C.	トン (TON)	—
トン is only in the well-known Japanese word for bedding: 布団.		

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Group	〈DUNKING〉 is a 〈TONIC〉.
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+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
一団	one + group = <i>a group</i>	イチダン (ICHIDAN)
団体	group + body = <i>organisation</i>	ダン・タイ (DANTAI)
団子	group + child = <i>dumpling</i>	ダン・ゴ (DAN-go)
入団	enter + group = <i>joining (a group)</i>	ニュー・ダン (NYŪDAN)
布団*	spread/linen + group = <i>bedding</i>	フ・トン (FU-TON)

{...} Sample Sentence		
内田さん	は	団子 が 好き です。
うちださん	は	ダンゴ が すき です
Uchida-san	は	dumplings が likes be / is
Uchida-san likes dumplings.		

漢字 8: Every (毎)

		
Every.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	𠂇 + 母
English	Person + Do not/Mother

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Every	[person] has a [mother].

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	マイ (MAI)	—
L.C.	—	ごと (goto)

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations	
Every	<goto> <MIGRATION>.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
Notice the mix of readings in the last three examples below.		
毎日	every + sun (day) = <i>daily</i>	マイニチ (MAINICHI)
毎週	every + week = <i>weekly</i>	マイ・シュウ (MAISHŪ)
*毎月	every + moon (month) = <i>monthly</i>	マイ・つき (MAItzuki)
*毎年	every + year = <i>yearly</i>	マイ・とし (MAItoshi)
*毎朝	every + morning = <i>every morning</i>	マイ・あさ (MAIasa)

{...} Sample Sentence		
毎日	何時	に 起きます か。
マイニチ	なんジ	に おきます か
every day	what time	に get up か
What time do you get up every day?		

漢字 9: Empty (空)

空

空

Empty. Sky.

As in English, *empty* can incorporate suggestions of *uselessness* and *futility*.

Composition

Glyphs	穴 + 工
English	Cave + Craft/Work

Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Empty 「caves」 are 「crafted」 out.

Pronunciations

音読み

訓読み

Cm.	クウ (KŪ)	そら、から (sora, kara)
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クウ is by far the most common reading in compounds.

そら, as shown in the first example, means *sky*; it becomes voiced in the second position (as in the second compound).

から occasionally appears in the first position with a meaning of *empty*, and is a reading you will no doubt be familiar with from the third example.

L.C.	—	あ (a)
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The あ reading is used to make the verbs 空く and 空ける. Meaning *to open*, these can be thought of as interchangeable with the more common 開く and 開ける from Entry ?? (page ??).

Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Empty <saw lumps> were <updated> to be <COOL> and <caramelized>.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
空	<i>sky</i>	そら (sora)
青空	blue + empty = <i>blue sky</i>	あおぞら (aozora)
空手	empty + hand = <i>karate</i>	からて (karate)
空間	empty + interval = <i>space</i>	クウ・カン (KŪ-KAN)
空気	empty + spirit = <i>air</i>	クウ・キ (KŪ-KI)
空く (intr.)	to be open	あく (aku)
空ける (tr.)	to open something	あける (akeru)
空き缶*	empty + can = <i>empty can</i>	あき・カン (aki-KAN)
空き瓶*	empty + bin = <i>empty bin</i>	あき・ビン (aki-BIN)

{...} Sample Sentence

朝	の	空	は	きれい	です	よ。
あさ	の	そら	は	きれい	です	よ
morning	の	skry	は	pretty	be / is	よ
The morning sky is lovely.						

漢字 10: Town (町)

町

町

Town, one size smaller than a city.

On occasion it can also refer to a *street* or an *alley*.

Composition

Glyphs	田 + 丁
English	Rice field + Block (5)

Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

A town of 「rice-field」 「blocks」.

Pronunciations

音読み

訓読み

Cm.	チョウ (CHŌ)	まち (machi)
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L.C.	—	—
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Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Town <marching> is such a <CHORE>.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
町	<i>town</i>	まち (machi)
町内	town + inside = <i>in the town</i>	チョウ・ナイ (CHŌ-NAI)
町立	town + stand = <i>established by the town</i>	チョウ・リツ (CHŌ-RITSU)
町会	town + meet = <i>town assembly</i>	チョウ・カイ (CHŌ-KAI)

{...} Sample Sentence

この町のラーメンは有名です。
kono machi no rāmen wa YŪMEI desu.
(this) (town) (ramen) (famous)
= This town's ramen is famous.

{...} Sample Sentence

此の町のラーメンは有名です。
このまちのラーメンはユウメイです
this town の ramen は famous be / is
This town's ramen is famous.

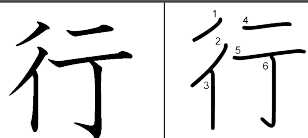
漢字 11: Dog (犬)		
		
Dog.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	犬	
English	Dog	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Part of the 漢字 radicals (#94).		
	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ケン (KEN)	いぬ (inu)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Dogs , like <inuyasha>, have <KENNELS>.		
‡Inuyasha is a famous アニメ character.		
+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
犬	<i>dog</i>	いぬ (inu)
子犬	child + dog = <i>puppy</i>	こいぬ (koinu)
秋田犬	autumn + rice field + dog = <i>an Akita dog</i>	あきた・ケン (akita·KEN)
愛犬	love + dog = <i>pet dog</i>	アイ・ケン (AIKEN)
愛犬家	love + dog + house = <i>dog lover</i>	アイ・ケン・カ (AIKEN-KA)
{...} Sample Sentence		
古川さんが子犬を買いました。		
Furukawa-san ga koinu o kaimashita.		
(Furukawa-san) (puppy) (bought)		
=Furukawa-san bought a puppy.		

漢字 12: Death (死)		
死		
Death.		
∈ Composition		
Glyphs	歹 + ヒ	
English	Death/Decay + Spoon/Ladle	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Death	[spoon].	
♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	シ (SHI)	し (shi)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Death ...There is no <SHIELD> against or <shifting> away from it.		
+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
死ぬ	<i>to die</i>	しぬ (shinu)
水死	water + death = <i>drowning</i>	スイ・シ (SUISHI)
死体	death + body = <i>dead body</i>	シ・タイ (SHITAI)
死火山	death + fire + mountain = <i>extinct volcano</i>	シ・カ・ザン (SHI-KA-ZAN)
{...} Sample Sentence		
私の好きな馬は五年前に死にました。		
watashi no suki na uma wa GO-NEN-mae ni shi-nimashita.		
(my) (like) (horse) (five years ago) (died)		
=My horse that I liked died five years ago.		

漢字 13: Go (行)



“Go” is the primary meaning of this character.

Related ideas are “carrying out” or “doing”.

Far less common is the secondary sense of a “stroke” or “line” of text.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	彳 + 一 + 丁
English	Step + One + Block (5)

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Go	[step] on [block] [one].
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♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	コウ (KŌ)	い、ゆ (i, yu)

For the general sense of the verb “to go”, *いく* is used; *ゆき* is employed far less often and is of most use in a few specific compounds (such as in the second example), or as a suffix meaning “bound for” (as in the third example).

L.C.	ギョウ、アン (GYŌ, AN)	おこな (okona)
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ギョウ is found primarily in compounds relating to this 漢字’s secondary meaning of “line” or “stroke”.

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Go <CAUSE> a <LONG-GYONE> <interesting> <yule> in <a corner> with your <UNCLE>.

[‡]Yule is a festival historically observed by the Germanic peoples.

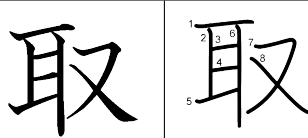
+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
行 can also act like 買, albeit strangely in that on rare occasions it will incorporate ゆく as opposed to ゆき. This is seen in the well-known compound 行方不明: “missing”.		
行く	<i>to go</i>	いく (iku)
行き先	go + precede = <i>destination</i>	ゆき さき (yuki saki)
東京行	east + capital + go = <i>bound for Tokyo</i>	トウキョウ ゆき (TŌKYŌ yuki)
夜行	night + go = <i>night travel</i>	ヤコウ (YAKŌ)
歩行	walk + go = <i>walking</i>	ホコウ (HOKŌ)
歩行者	walk + go + individual = <i>pedestrian</i>	ホコウシャ (HOKŌSHA)
行方不明	go + direction + negative + bright = <i>missing</i>	ゆくえフメイ (yukue FUMEI)

{...} Sample Sentence

今日は歩行者が多い。
kyō wa HOKŌSHA ga ōi.
(today) (pedestrians) (many)
= <i>There are many pedestrians today.</i>

漢字 14: Take (取)



Take.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	耳 + 又
English	Ear + Again

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Take	[again] and again my [ear].
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♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	—	と (to)
L.C.	シュ (SHU)	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

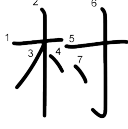
Take	on the <torrential> <SHOOTING>.
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+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
As the second example shows, this 漢字 can act like 買.		
It can also become voiced in the second position, as shown here in the final compound.		
取る	<i>to take</i>	とる (toru)
取引	take + pull = <i>transactions</i>	とりひき (torihiki)
取り上げる	take + upper = <i>to pick up</i>	とり あげる (tori ageru)
取り入れる	take + enter = <i>to take in</i>	とり いれる (tori ireru)
取り出す	take + exit = <i>to take out</i>	とり だす (tori dasu)
気取る	spirit + take = <i>to put on airs</i>	キ どる (KI doru)

{...} Sample Sentence
赤とうがらしを取り出して下さい。
akatōgarashi o tori dashite kudasai.
(red peppers) (take out) (please)
= <i>Please take out the red peppers.</i>

漢字 15: Village (村)

		
Village. Keep in mind that this character implies something smaller than a city or town.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	木 + 寸
English	Tree + Tiny

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Villages [trees] are [tiny].

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ソン (SON)	むら (mura)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Village <SONGS> depicted in the <mural>.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
Note that the reading for 人 in the second example is voiced.		
村	village	むら (mura)
村人	village + person = villager	むらびと (mura-bito)
山村	mountain + village = mountain village	サン・ソン (SAN-SON)

{...} Sample Sentence

村人は小道に立っています。
mura-bito wa komichi ni tatte imasu.
(villager) (path) (is standing)
= A villager is standing in the path.

漢字 16: Character (字)

		
“Character” in the sense of a Chinese character or letter of an alphabet.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	宀 + 子
English	Roof + Child

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
The character of a [child] under a [roof].

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ジ (JI)	—
L.C.	—	あざ (aza)

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Characters in the <azalea> <JIG>.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
Note that the reading for 引 is voiced in the final example.		
十字	ten + character = a cross	ジュウ・ジ (JŪ·JI)
赤十字	red + ten + character = The Red Cross	セキ・ジュウ・ジ (SEKI·JŪ·JI)
字引	character + pull = dictionary	ジ・びき (JI·biki)

{...} Sample Sentence

多くの国では赤十字は大切です。
ōku no kuni de wa SEKI·JŪ·JI wa TAISETSU desu.
(many) (country) (Red Cross) (important)
= The Red Cross is important in many countries.

漢字 17: Tool (具)

Tool. Equipment.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	目 + 一 + 八
English	Eye + One + Eight/Volcano

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Tools	numbered [one] through [eight] were [eyed].

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	グ (GU)	—
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Tool <GOOFING>.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
道具	road + tool = <i>tool</i>	ドウ・グ (DŌ-GU)
家具	house + tool = <i>furniture</i>	カ・グ (KA-GU)
具体	tool + body = <i>definite/concrete</i>	グ・タイ (GU-TAI)
馬具	horse + tool = <i>harness</i>	バ・グ (BA-GU)

{...} Sample Sentence

山下先生は新しい家具を買いました。

Yamashita-sensei wa atarashii KA-GU o kaimashita.

(teacher Yamashita) (new) (furniture) (bought)

= Yamashita-sensei bought new furniture.

漢字 18: Pour (注)

Pour.		
“Directing” something toward an object (a gaze or one’s attention, for instance).		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	氵 + 主
English	Water + Pour (4)

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Pour	「water」 「primarily」.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	チュウ (CHŪ)	そそ (soso)
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Pour <so-so> while <CHEWING>.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
注ぐ	<i>to pour</i>	そそ・ぐ (sosogu)
注意	pour + mind = <i>attention</i>	チュウ・イ (CHŪ-I)
注水	pour + water = <i>watering</i>	チュウ・スイ (CHŪ-SUI)
注入	pour + enter = <i>infusion</i>	チュウ・ニュウ (CHŪ-NYŪ)
注目	pour + eye = <i>notice</i>	チュウ・モク (CHŪ-MOKU)

{...} Sample Sentence

犬に注意して下さい。

inu ni CHŪ-I shite kudasai.

(dog) (attention) (do) (please)

= Watch out for the dog.

漢字 19: Goods (品)

This character expresses the idea of “goods” or “articles” in the majority of compounds in which it appears.

It can occasionally have the more abstract notion of “refinement”. The fourth and the fifth examples below illustrate this aspect of its meaning.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	品
English	Goods

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

An uncommon 漢字 radical.

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ヒン (HIN)	しな (shina)
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The goods <she nudged> at was a (HINT).

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
Note how the second character in example three has become voiced.		
品	goods	しな (shina)
品物	goods + thing = <i>merchandise</i>	しなもの (shina-mono)
品切れ	goods + cut = “ <i>out of stock</i> ”	しな ぎれ (shina gire)
上品	upper + goods = <i>elegant</i>	ジョウ・ヒン (JŌ-HIN)
下品	lower + goods = <i>vulgar</i>	ゲ・ヒン (GEHIN)
中古品	middle + old + goods = <i>secondhand goods</i>	チュウ・コ・ヒン (CHŪ-KO-HIN)

{...} Sample Sentence

下品な人ですね。
GEHIN na hito desu ne.
(vulgar) (person) (is)
= (He's) a vulgar person, isn't he?

漢字 20: Hamlet (里)

Hamlet. Here we have the fourth and smallest of our populated units.

This character can also signify the “countryside” in general; not surprisingly, given how small a settlement this 漢字 implies.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	里
English	Village/3.93 km/2.44 miles

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Part of the 漢字 radicals (#166).

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	—	さと (sato)
L.C.	リ (RI)	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Hamlet caused a <subtle> (LEAP) in my heart.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
The final compound below reminds us once again that this reading of 人 is always voiced when it appears in the second position.		
里	hamlet	さと (sato)
古里	old + hamlet = <i>the old hometown</i>	ふるさと (furusato)
里人	hamlet + person = <i>country folk</i>	さとびと (satobito)

{...} Sample Sentence

先週は古里へ行きました。
SENSHŪ wa furusato e ikimashita.
(last week) (old hometown) (went)
= Last week I went to my old hometown.

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B			Dog	犬	8	G			Primary	主	4
Block	丁	5	E			Go	行	9	Public	公	3
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漢字 by Stroke Count

2 Strokes		犬	8	死	8	8 Strokes	
丁	5	5 Strokes		每	6	具	12
3 Strokes		主	4	行	9	取	9
巾	3	市	4	7 Strokes		注	12
4 Strokes		6 Strokes		村	11	空	7
公	3	団	6	町	7	9 Strokes	
友	5	字	11	里	13	品	13